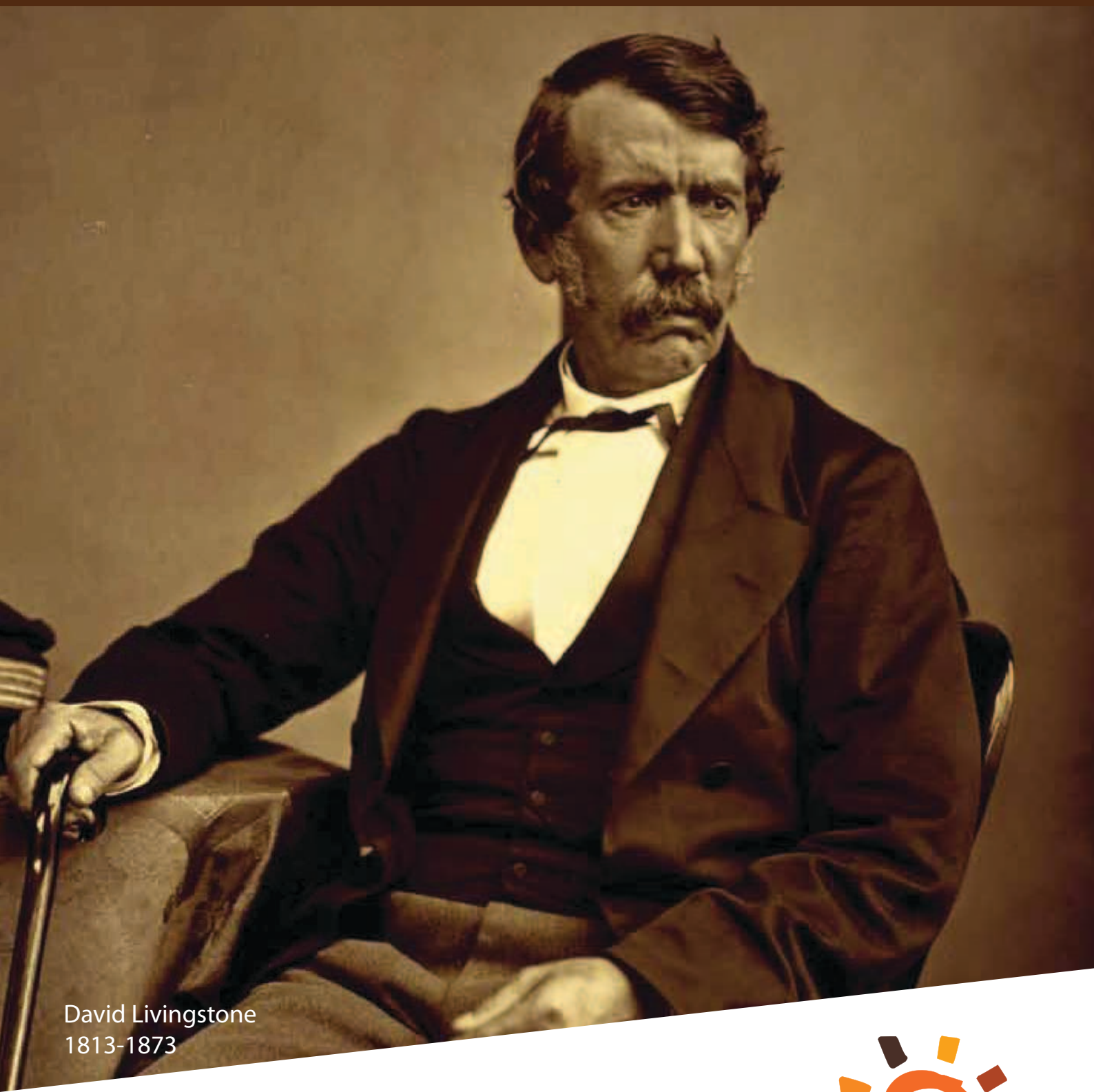
the zebra's VOICE

2013•EDITION ONE



David Livingstone
1813-1873

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The Zebra's Voice welcome articles, photographs and illustrations from those involved or interested in cultural and natural heritage.
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Editor's note

Two hundred years have passed since the birth and death of Dr. David Livingstone, the missionary, doctor, reseacher and explorer! Dr. David Livingstone's travels and stay in Botswana are notably marked by sites which include: the Livingstone's tree, Dimawe and Mma Sechele's cave at Manyana, and Legaga La Ga Kobokwe at Molepolole. Dr. Livingstone the explorer traversed the southern and eastern regions of Africa and as a doctor and reseacher, he promoted the use of quinine as the cure for malaria in those regions. In Botswana he is mostly remembered for his missionary work and medical practice. It is my hope that articles in this edition will generate interest in the *genuinely radical nature of David Livingstone* which *remains distorted by his post humous transformation into a colonial stereotype of the great explorer and bumanitarian imperialist icon* as noted by Dr. Jeff Ramsay in his article contained in this edition.

We are grateful to all those who contributed to make this special edition possible.

Malomatsebe

Go setse go fetile dingwaga di le makgolo mabedi morago ga loso la ga Ngaka David Livingstone, yo e neng e le Moreri wa lefoko la Modimo, ngaka, modira dipatlisiso ebile e le motho yo o kgatlhegelang go tsamaya le lefatshe a bona mafelo a a farologanyeng. Ditso tsa go nna ga gagwe mo lefatsheng la Botswana a bo a tsaya maeto go bona dikarolo tse di farologanyeng tsa lone, di bonwa mo mafelong a a akaretsang Kolobeng, setlhare sa ga Livingstone, Dimawe le legaga la ga Mma Sechele kwa Manyana mmogo le legaga la ga Kobokwe kwa Molepolole. Mo Botswana o gopolwa thata ka bodiredi jwa gagwe jwa go phatlalatsa sekeresete le jwa bongaka.

Ngaka Livingstone o ne a tsamaya le dikgaolo tsa borwa le botlhaba jwa Aferika a le mo letsholong la bongaka le go dira dipatlisiso mme a anamisa kitso ka tiriso ya molemo o o bidiwang quinine go alafa bolwetse jwa letshoroma mo go tsone dikgaolo tseo.Tsholofelo ke gore dipolelo tse di mo kgatisong e di tla ngoka kgatlhego ya babadi go itse thata ka boleng jwa ga ngaka Livingstone jaaka morotloetsi wa diphetogo tsa matshelo a batho le sepolotiki, ka jaana e ne ya re morago ga loso lwa gagwe ga buiwa ka ene jaaka ekete o sekametse ntlheng ya sekolone.Tse ke dingwe tsa dintlha tse di tlhagelelang mo polelong ya ga Dr Jeff Ramsay e e mo go yone kgatiso e.

Re leboga botlhe ba ba nnileng le seabe mo kgatisong ya dipolelo tse.

Before Kolobeng

Dr Fred Morton, University of Botswana

Before David Livingstone and African evangelist Paul Mebalwe followed Sechele into present-day Botswana and settled at Kolobeng in 1847, Livingstone had spent the previous four years in South Africa in the hilly area between Zeerust and present-day Madikwe Game Reserve and taking three journeys east into the Transvaal. Livingstone's writing of these years provides the first glimpse of the areas between southeast Botswana and present-day Pretoria after Mzilikazi had been expelled from the area in 1837.



Remains of Livingstone's house, Kolobeng

In 1843 he, Mebalwe, and fellow LMS missionary Roger Edwards established a mission station at Mabotsa, capital of Mosielele's Bakgatla -Ba -Ga Mmanaana. Mabotsa was located about 15 kilometers southeast of Ramotswa near the present town of Moshana. In 1845, after a falling out with Edwards, Livingstone and Mebalwe relocated to Chonwane, located on the western slopes of the Dwarsberg, 10-12 kms northeast of Mabotsa. There, Sechele and his Kwena faction had been based following the civil wars afflicting the Kwena for the previous several years. At Chonwane, Sechele and Livingstone became mutual admirers, and Livingstone would make Sechele his first,and only convert to Christianity.

Though based in Mabotsa and Chonwane, Livingstone was frequently away, revealing his penchant for travel and exploration that came to mark his career. Among his ventures were three journeys east toward present-day Rustenburg and Polokwane, covering an area by then the domain of the Voortrekkers who had driven Mzilikazi north for good and who claimed the territory was their own by right of conquest. Many Tswana people who had been dislocated from this territory during the era of Sebetwane, Mzilikazi and Potgieter, returned to their home territories to find themselves subjects of the Boer immigrants. Livingstone's aim in travelling east from

Mabotsa was to test the waters for establishing future LMS missions headed by African evangelists in the likes of Mebalwe. He had had little prior contact with these people or their new rulers, but he hoped that as Christians, the Boers would be willing to permit the LMS to start missions among their African subjects. He was encouraged by "very friendly messages,"and an invitation to Livingstone to visit, from Mokgatle-a-Thethe, Kgosi of the Bafokeng.

But he should have been forewarned that the Boers were unlikely to be as welcoming. Already Livingstone had received a letter from Commandant Gerrit
Kruger (uncle of Paul Kruger, future President of the Boer South African Republic) wanting to know what business he had in Chonwane and hinting that they were inclined to come and seize firearms belonging to Sechele.
Livingstone was soon to learn that the Boers suspected him of dealing with the 'natives' in firearms.

Undeterred (when was Livingstone ever deterred?), he and Mebalwe proceeded to Mokgatle's, went on to see Mamogale of the Bakwena Ba-Ga Mogopa and then visited Commandant Kruger, to whom Livingstone declared his intention of spreading Christianity. We must remind ourselves that Livingstone and Mebalwe, apart from John Moffat, were the only persons in these parts who were fluent in English, Setswana, and Dutch. In other words, they were able to speak directly with everyone they met on the way, without interpreters. After returning to Chonwane to complete building their houses, they journeyed east once more. After encountering "many villages we had not seen on our previous journey" they reached Seamoga of the Bakwena Ba-Ga Mmakau east of present-day Rustenburg, then turned north to Makapanstad and visited the Bakgatla Ba-Ga-Mosetlha "a large tribe consisting of about a dozen villages…They knew nothing of missionaries, but we found no difficulty in collecting them in large numbers." Another six days northeast took them to Mankopane, capital of the Laka, a people rich in cattle

Livingstone's letters of his treks by foot into the Transvaal reveal what the Batswana living there experienced as subjects of Boer rule. "Each chief," he observed "when called upon is obliged to furnish…as many men as any piece of work may require and…no wages are paid for labour as labour is exacted in payment of being allowed to live in the land of ther forefathers." Africans living away from Boer rule were targeted in raids for cattle and slaves. They employed their African subjects to assist. In an attack on the Kwena-Moletsi, "by employing their African allies…immense booty was secured…10,000 sheep and 400 captives included…."

Two years, later, in 1849, Livingstone and Mebalwe returned to the Transvaal, this time adding the Bakgatla Ba-Ga- Kgafela to his list of encounters. He recorded the first description of young Kgamanyane(who had just succeeded the late Pilane) as an "agreeable youth, very friendly, & has a large tribe." Livingstone's presence aroused the suspicions of none other than Andries Potgieter. After starting to erect a shelter for Mebalwe to live in at Mokgatle's capital, the Evangelist and Livingstone were confronted by the Boer leader. He had the idea, Livingstone gathered, "that we had come to take possession of the land for the English government." In a meeting with Potgieter and J.L. Pretorius, Livingstone was told that if he were to establish a mission at Mokgatle's, a commando would drive Mokgatle and his people to the Limpopo. "I put it to Potgieter," Livingstone recalled, "that if he hindered the gospel the guilt of the loss of many souls would rest on his head." Potgeiter tossed off the remark it "tickled the old gentlemen dreadfully"

Convinced that any mission would bring down the wrath of suspicious Boers on the head of any chief who accepted an evangelist, Livingstone abandoned his notion of extending the LMS to the East. Within a year, he had followed Sechele to Kolobeng, a fine stream about 40 miles N.W. of Chonuane and after examining it we were glad to remove to the blessed sound of gurgling waters." From this point, Livingstone's vision of Christian expansion was directed to the north, in areas beyond Boer control.

Of course, three short years later, in 1852, Sechele by then having moved to Dimawe, would be attacked by a large commando of Boers from the very area Livingstone had travelled previously. Their destruction of Livingstone's Kolobeng home and everything inside, expressed the disdain for the missionary that had seeped out in Potgieter's laughter. They did not defeat Sechele, but they did return to the Transvaal with more than 600 captives who had become slaves, to be used as domestic servants and for other duties on Boer farms. In the coming years, thousands of captives were taken from the edges of the South African Republic, as it was known after 1852. From this point, Livingstone's letters began a campaign to expose the Boers as slave raiders and traders, anticipating the doctor's later martyrdom in exposing slave trading in central and eastern Africa, where his journeys from Botswana led him.

Pele ga Kolobeng

Dr Fred Morton, Unibesithi Ya Botswana

Pele ga Moruti Ngaka David Livingstone le Moenfangedi Paul Mebalwe ba tsena mo lefatsheng le e leng Botswana gompieno, ba bo ba thibelela kwa Kolobeng ka 1847,Livingstone o ne a tsere dingwaga di le nne pele ga moo a nna kwa Aferika Borwa fa gare ga Zeerust le lefelo le e leng la diphologolo la Madikwe gompieno. O ne a tloga a tsamaela kwa botlhabatsatsi kwa Teransefala. Mekwalo ya gagwe ya dingwaga tseo e supa fa e bile ya nna yone nako e a neng a bona e le lantlha mafelo a a ikadileng fa gare ga Pretoria le borwa -botlhaba jwa lefatshe leno.

Ka 1843, Mebalwe le moreri yo mongwe wa lefoko la Modimo yo o neng a bidiwa Rodger Edwards go tswa kwa lekgotleng la London Missionary Society ba ne ba simolodisa boremelelo jwa thero ya lefoko la Modimo kwa Mabotsa , motse mogolo wa Bakgatla ba ga Mmanaana, Ba ga Kgosi Mosielele Lefelo le la Mabotsa le ne le le dikhilomithara di le lesome le botlhano kwa borwa botlhaba jwa motse wa Ramotswa, gaufi le Moshana. Ka 1845, morago ga go nna le dipharologanyo le Edwards, Livingstone le Mebalwe ba ne ba fudugela kwa Chonwane, dikhilomithara di le lesome go ya kwa go tse di lesome le bobedi kwa bokone botlhaba jwa Mabotsa. Ke gone kwa ba neng ba kopana le Kgosi Sechele I le morafe wa gagwe wa Bakwena, ba ba neng ba thibeletse foo morago ga dingwaga di le mmalwa tsa dintwa tsa maraganateng. Morago ga go itsane le Kgosi Sechele, Livingstone o ne a mo sokololela mo tumelong ya sekeresete.

Le fa a ne a nna kwa Mabotsa le Chonwane ,Livingstone o ne a sa ipone tsapa go tsamaya mo mafelong a a farologanyeng go ithuta dilo tse disha. Mangwe a mafelo a a tsamaileng mo go one ke a a mo tikologong ya Rustenburg le Polokwane kwa bontsi jwa banni ba teng e ne e le maburu ba ba neng ba re lefatshe leo ke la bone ka e le bone ba lelekileng Matebele a ga Mzilikazi mo go lone. Le fa go ntse jalo ba ne ba gapile merafe mengwe ya Batswana e e neng e nna mo kgaolong eo pele ga dintwa le Mzilikazi le Sebetwane. Maikaelelo a ga Livingstone mo go eteleng mafelo ao e ne e le go sekaseka gore a seemo se siametse gore o ka tlhoma boremelelo jwa thero ya lefoko la Modimo teng. Go ne ga felela go supagala gore Maburu a ne a sa amogele maikaelelo a gagwe ka jaana a ne a setse a amogetse lekwalo le le tswang kwa moeteleding pele a bone, Gerrit Kruger fa ba bata go gapa ditlhobolo tsa ga Sechele. Ngaka Livingstone o ne a lemoga gore ba ne ba belaela gore o rekisetsa bantsho ditlhobolo.

Le fa go ntse jalo o ne a tswelela a etela Kgosi Mamogale wa Bakwena ba ga Mogopa, Kgosi Seamoga wa Bakwena ba ga Mmakau le Bakgatla ba ga Mosetlha. Mekwalo ya gagwe e supa fa a ne a tswelela a tsenelela mo teransefala kwa a neng a itemogela ka fa bantsho ba neng ba tshela ka teng ka fa tlase ga puso ya Maburu. Ba ne ba berekela beng ba boneka bokete mme bas a bone dituelo dipe, go twe tuelo ya bone ke gore ba nna mo lefatsheng la borrabone mogolwagolwane. Merafe ya bantsho e e neng e se ka fa tlase ga puso ya bone ba ne ba tlhaselwa go gapiwa dikgomo le batho b aba neng ba ntshiwa makgoba.

Ka 1849, Livingstone le Mebalwe ba ne ba ne ba boela kwa Teransefala mme ba etela Bakgatla ba ga Kgafela. Morago ga go tlhoma motlaagana wa ga Mebalwe gore a direle mo kgaolong eo a nna mo go one. Moeteledipele wa Maburu Andries Potgieter o ne a ba lemotsha fa a sa itumelele go nna teng ga bone mo kgaolong eo, go supagala fa a ne a dumela gore ba batla go gapa lefatshe leo mo boemong jwa mmuso wa Ennyelane. Potgieter o ne a supa gore fa go ka tlhongwa boremelelo jwa thero ya lefoko la Modimo mo kgaolong eo, o tla lelekela Bakgatla kwa Limpopo. Ngaka Livingstone o ne a araba ka gore fa a ka kganela go anamisiwa ga mafoko a a molemo o tla rwala boikarabelo jwa go latlhega ga mewa e e neng e

k a bo e bolokilwe.

Ka go lemoga fa go tsweledisa thero ya mafoko a a molemo mo kgaolong eo go ka dira gore Maburu a ntshetse bogale jwa bone mo dikgosing tsa merafe e e agileng foo, Livingstone o ne a tlogela maikaelelo a gagwe a go dira jalo mme a tsamaela kwa Kolobeng. Ka 1852, Maburu a ne a tlhasela Bakwena ba ga Sechele ba jaanong ba neng ba nna kwa Dimawe. Ba ne ba senya legae la ga Livingstone le tsotlhe tse di neng di le mo go lone. Le ntswa ba ne ba sa kgona go fenya Bakwena, ba ne ba gapa batho ba le makgolo a marataro go ya go ba dira makgoba mo dipolaseng tsa bone. Go tloga ka nako eo, Livingstone o ne a bolotsa letsholo la go upolola ditiro tsa Maburu tsa go ntsha batho makgoba, bogolo jang mo Aferika Borwa, kwa borwa ga mmogo le kwa botlhaba jwa Aferika.



Legaga la ga Kobokwe, Molepolole

The Climate and Environment at Kolobeng

David J. Nash, School of Environment and Technology, University of Brighton, Brighton, UK.

The environmental conditions David Livingstone experienced at Kolobeng, where he established his first mission station in 1847, played a pivotal role in shaping his opinions about the climate of Africa. When he arrived at Kolobeng in August 1847, Livingstone was full of optimism[1] . The Kolobeng River was in full flow, tumbling over rocks and spreading out onto a floodplain some 5.5 metres wide and around 1 metre deep in the middle. There were bushbuck, zebra, kudu, hyena and rhinoceros in the area. Broken branches indicated that elephant had been present. He raised a hut to live in and in September 1847, with the support of the BaKwêna of Chief Sechele, constructed a meeting house for religious teaching[2] – effectively the first church in Botswana.

We know from a letter written by the London Missionary Society (LMS) missionary Rogers Edwards at nearby Mabotsa that the 1847-48 rainy season had begun with "abundant rains"[3] ; by the end of the year Livingstone was anticipating "…the prospect of an abundance of both native and European produce"[4] .Heavy rains continued until at least March 1848, leading William Ross of the LMS Mamusa mission station to write: "We have had a remarkable season of excellent rains"[5]

Livingstone's optimism, and the period of above average rains, appears to have been short-lived. The wet summer of 1847-48 was followed by a run of drought years[6]. . In a letter to his father in November 1848, Livingstone wrote: "We have no rain - one good shower alone this year while all around us the rains have been abundant. The Kolobeng gets smaller and smaller but has not run into the water course for the last three weeks."[7] . Despite reports of heavy showers in Livingstone's letters, the succeeding rainy seasons appear to have been equally dry. Livingstone describes the increasingly desperate situation at Kolobeng in his book Missionary Travels and Researches in South Africa:" In our second year again no rain fell. In the third year the same extraordinary drought followed. Indeed, not ten inches of water fell



Kolobeng river

during these two years, and the Kolobeng ran dry; so many fish were killed that the hyenas from the whole country round collected to the feast, and were unable to finish the putrid mass… the fourth year was equally unpropitious, the fall of rain being insufficient to bring the grain to maturity." [8]

We know from letters written by other missionaries that drought conditions did not just affect Kolobeng, but were felt over much of southern Botswana and the Northern Cape of South Africa[9] . The run of drought years only ended during the rainy season of 1851-52, when normal or above-average rainfall occurred across central southern Africa[1.0] However, by this time, Livingstone had abandoned the Kolobeng mission. The family had travelled to Cape Town, from where Mary and the Livingstone children returned to England on 1 May 1852[11] . Livingstone himself travelled to Kuruman and then continued onward to explore the region north of Lake Ngami and the Zambezi River. Kolobeng mission was plundered by a Commando of Boers on 27 September 1852[12].

Livingstone's experiences of semi-continuous drought, first in Kuruman from 1844-46 and then in Kolobeng from 1847-51, had a profound impact upon his scientific views[13] . He was firmly of the opinion that Africa was desiccating, and drew upon the accounts of long-established missionaries, including Robert Moffat, to support this theory. As early as 1843, he wrote in a letter to John Drummond at the LMS in London: "Perhaps you are not yet aware this country is becoming warmer, the fountains are drying up and there is the strongest evidence that at one period, this instead of being as it is now, chiefly a sterile waste, was one of the finest watered countries in the world."[14] Although in his later letters he acknowledged that droughts and wet years in the southern Kalahari probably occurred in cycles[15], he continued to promote his desiccation theory in influential publications such as Missionary Travels.

By the end of the 19th century, popularised by organisations such as the British Association for the Advancement of Science and the Royal Geographical Society, the desiccation of Africa had effectively become "truth" [16]. Even though this theory has since been disproven, there can be no doubt that the climate and environment at Kolobeng had an important influence upon this long-held view[17] .

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Tikologo ya Kolobeng

David J. Nash

Seemo sa tikologo se Moruti Ngaka David Livingstone a kopaneng le sone kwa Kolobeng ka 1847 jaaka a ne a tlhoma boremelelo jwa go gasa lefoko la Modimo, ke sone se se neng sa tlhotlheletsa dikakanyo tsa gagwe ka seemo sa loapi sa mo Aferika. Fa a goroga kwa Kolobeng ka kgwedi ya Phatwe mo ngwageng oo o ne a tletse tsholofelo. Noka ya Kolobeng e ne e elela ebile go bonala diphologolo ka go farologana jaaka dipitse tsa naga, diphiri le ditshukudu, jalo jalo.

Go ya ka mokwalo wa ga Rogers Edwards yo le ene e neng e le moreri wa lefoko la Modimo, paka ya dipula ya ngwaga wa 1847/48 e simologile sentle ka dipula tse di namagadi mo Livingstone a neng a na le tsholofelo ya thobo e e nametsang kwa bokhutlong jwa paka eo. Dipula tseo di ne tsa tswelela go fitlhelela ka kgwedi ya Mopitlo ka 1848, mme seemo seo sa seka sa nna jalo ka lebaka le le leele ka jaana go ne ga latela dingwaga tsa leuba le komelelo.

Mo lekwalong le a le kwaletseng rraagwe ka kgwedi ya Ngwanatsele ka 1848, Livingstone o ne a bolela fa go sena pula ebile metsi a noka ya Kolobeng a ntse a fokotsega ka monokela. Mo bukeng ya gagwe ka ga maeto le ditlhotlhomiso tse dineng di dirwa ke bareri ba lefoko la Modimo mo borwa jwa Aferika, Livingstone o ne a tlhalosa fa dingwaga di ne tsa tllhatlologana di le tharo go ntse go sena pula, noka ya Kolobeng ya kgala, ditlhapi di le dintsi tsa swa tsa ba tsa nna mojo wa bophiri tse le tsone di neng tsa palelwa ke go fetsa sebodu seo.

Mekwalo ya bareri ba lefoko la Modimo mo kgaolong e ,e ne ya supa fa leuba le le ne le sa ama Kolobeng fela mme le ne le kokonetse borwa jwa Botswana jotlhe le bokone jwa Kapa kwa Aferika Borwa. Komelelo e e ne ya fela ka paka ya dipula ya 1851-52 fa dipula tse di nametsang di ne di na mo bogare jwa borwa jwa Aferika.

Le fa go ntse jalo, ka nako eo Livingstone o ne a setse a fudugile kwa Kolobeng go ya kwa Kapa, kwa e rileng ba fitlha teng ,mohumagadi wa gagwe Mary le bana ba boela kwa Ennyelane fa Motsheganong a rogwa ka 1852. Ngaka Livingstone ene o ne a tswelela le mesepele ya gagwe a tsamaela kwa letsheng la Ngami le noka ya Zambezi. Boago jwa gagwe kwa Kolobeng jone bo ne jwa senngwa ke Maburu kgwedi ya Lwetse e le masome mabedi le bosupa ka 1852.

Go itemogela seemo sa leuba ga ga Livingstone kwa Kuruman mo dingwageng tsa 1844-46 le kwa Kolobeng mo dingwageng tsa 1847-51, go ne ga nna le tlhotlheletso mo dikakanyong tse a neng a nna le tsone ka ga seemo sa loapi mo mafelong ao. O ne a dumela gore Aferika o a kgala mme a dirisa mekwalo ya bareri ba lefoko la Modimo ba bangwe ba ba neng ba ntse ba direla mo Aferika go netefatsa se a se buang.

Mo lekwalong le a le kwaletseng John Drummond, mokaulengwe wa gagwe yo a neng a le kwa Lontone ka 1843 one a re " Gongwe ga le ise le lemoge, lefelo le le ntse le a thuthafala, metswedi e a kgala mme go na le bosupi jo bo nonofileng jwa gore nako nngwe e ne e le lengwe la mafelo a a nang le metsi a mantsi go feta a mangwe mo lefatsheng ka bophara." Le ntswa mo mekwalong ya gagwe e e neng ya latela morago ga moo, o ne a supa fa a dumela gore gongwe dingwaga tsa leuba le tsa dipula tse di namagadi di tla ka go fapaana, o ne a tswelela ka go anamisa mogopolo oo wa gore Aferika o a kgala, mo dikgatisong tse di farologanyeng tsa botlhokwa jaaka buka ya gagwe ka ga mesepele ya bareri ba lefoko la Modimo mo mafelong a a farologanyeng.

Kwa bokhutlong jwa dingwaga tsa bo 1800, mogopolo oo o ne o setse o tumisitswe ke makgotla a tshwana le British Association For The Advancement Of Science le la Royal Geographical Society, le fa e rile morago batlhotlhomisi ba bangwe ba supa fa go sa nna jaaka a ne a akanya..

Livingstone on the Righteousness of Armed Resistance

Dr. Jeff Ramsay

During the 1840s the emerging armed struggle by Batswana against Boer oppression was brought to the attention of an influential segment of British public opinion in the pages of the *British Banner*, a weekly Christian newspaper of liberal and non-conformist views. In its 4th July 1849 edition, an article entitled "The Peacemakers of the Interior of South Africa" appeared by a correspondent who was identified only as "a surgeon".

The article's opening paragraph was unconventional. Maintaining that "there is a cause for everything", it speculated on the possibility that the downfall of two once formidable French emperors was divine justice for their imperialist crimes:

"Toussaint Louverture was sent to France to drag out his days in a dungeon, and the man who sent him thither was sent to rusticate on the rock of St. Helena. Queen Pomare was driven into exile, but carried with her the sympathies of the Christian portion of Christendom, and Louis Phillip has been driven to England, and there he will probably drivel out his days with the sympathy of those who have few driblets thereof to spare".

"We have all speculated on the causes which led to the overthrow of Napoleon of war and the Napoleon of peace, and no doubt there were other ends to be answered in their humiliation than those of trampling on the rights of the negro general of Hayti (Haiti) and the Christian Queen of Tahiti; but the similarity of states to which the oppressor and oppressed were reduced, seems to intimate something more than mere coincidences. They posses all the appearance of one of those exercises of lex talionis (law of retaliation) by the moral governor of the Universe, which frequently occur in real life."

In the eyes of the writer slavery and colonial conquest were thus sinful, while the anti-colonial resistance of Louverture and Pomare was in each case therefore virtuous.

In the same article, the author did not spare his own country, also expressing empathy for the anti-colonial resistance of the Xhosa against the British Cape Colony.

In was in the context of such perceptions, that the correspondent introduced his readers to conditions on the South African Highveld, where the material roots of oppression, as well as the identity of both the oppressor and oppressed, were for him clear:

"The principal reason why the Boer or Dutch emigrants left the colony i.e. the Great Trek, was discontent with the ordinance which proclaimed freedom to the slave. Here, then, they found they could indulge in their propensity to slaveholding, without the stigma attached to the name. Whoever required a piece of work done, just rode over to the nearest Bechuana town and ordered the chief to furnish twenty or thirty men or women, as the case required. In the majority of cases when the work was finished they were dismissed without even a morsel of food".

The article further spoke of "the seeds of war" thus being sown among the Batswana:
"The work which in former years was endurable is now grinding the natives to the earth. Every succeeding year will only add to the burdens. From one end of the country to the other the cry is that oppression is ten times more severe than when they were under Moselekatse. We witnessed the entire female population of one town turned out to weed one of these slave holders' fields. We have seen the scars inflicted by a whip made of the untanned hide of the rhinoceros; and these scars may be seen on the bare backs of even the chiefs and principal men in the tribes."

The correspondent concluded with the warning that:
"The natives know well their source of power. Guns and ammunition are purchased with great avidity, but concealed with such care, only a small number of Boers have any idea of the mine which may yet be sprung. In solemn council Potgieter issued orders that no trader should be allowed to introduce these weapons, and he thinks his orders are effectual. He might as well have bolted the castle gate with a boiled carrot."

The author behind the above passages was Rev. Dr. David Livingstone, who was then living at Kolobeng among the Bakwena of Kgosi Sechele I. By the time of its publication he was himself wanted by the Commandant-General of the Transvaal Boers, Andries Potgieter, for his own alleged role in arming the Bakwena.

Livingstone's radicalism went beyond denunciation of racism, slavery and colonial crimes. A restless man of action, his firsthand witnessing of the oppression of Batswana by the Boers in the Transvaal ultimately drove him to become a covert participant in the provision of then sophisticated weapons technology to Kgosi Sechele. This aspect of his life which is best reflected in his surviving private letters to a handful of individuals, including members of his family, as well as to his father-in law Robert Moffat who acted as a facilitator, e.g. Livingstone writing to Moffat August 1850: "Can you get the bullet mould (perhaps 2, & ramrods to fit) of 8 to lb. or rather fit 8 to the pound bore but conical, from Birmingham? Those which have an indentation behind fire much further, the dotted line marking the indentation. Sechele is very anxious to get the seven-barrelled gun. You seem to have forgotten it.'"

Writing to his brother Charles May 1849, when the Boers were openly threatening to remove him, he candidly explained his position:
"The Boers or Dutch emigrants oppress these tribes and treat them almost as slaves. They would have contrived to do so to Sechele too, but I succeeded in freeing the Bakwains. A considerable number of guns were purchased, and as this is the source of power of the Boers over the other tribes they began to be afraid that the other tribes would follow his example."

In a November 1950 letter to his parents he further affirmed that:
"Resistance to such tyrants and murderers i.e. Boers is I think obedience to God, and Charles will no doubt enlighten you on the point. The only means which with divine blessing have preserved our independence as a people are those very guns which you think the people would have been better off without. The tribe would have never enjoyed the gospel but for firearms."

This year marks the 200th anniversary of Livingstone's birth. While this milestone has led to a number of commemorations here in Botswana and elsewhere in the region, as well as in his native Scotland, in popular memory his actual legacy remains distorted by his posthumous transformation into a colonial stereotype - the great explorer and humanitarian imperialist icon, which has largely obscured his genuinely radical nature. In 2013 this is a legacy that deserves to be rescued and further explored.

Mogopolo wa ga Livingstone ka go Iphemela ka Dibetsa

Dr. Jeff Ramsay

Ka dingwaga tsa bo 1840, go simologa ga go itwela ga merafe ya Batswana kgatlhanong le go kgokgontshiwa ke Maburu, go ne ga lemogwa ke ba le bantsi kwa Ennyelane jaaka go ne go begwa ka gone mo pampiring ya dikgang ya sekeresete e e bidiwang *British Banner*. Mo go yone go ne go na le polelo e e reng " Baletlanyi Ba Kwa Borwa Jwa Aferika". Polelo e e nee tlhalosa gore sengwe le sengwe se se diragalang go a bo go na le lebaka. E ne e bile e supa gore go fenngwa ga bagogi bangwe ba lefatshe la Fora, ba ba neng ba kile ba bo ba na le dithata tse dikgolo, e ne e le kotlhao mo go bone ka ntlha ya ditiro tsa bone tse di sa siamang.

Mokwadi wa polelo eo, o ne a tlhalosa gore mokgwa wa go dira batho makgoba le go tseela ba bangwe lefatshe la bone ka tsela ya sekolone ke sebe, mme go itwela kgatlhanong le ditiro tse ke selo se se amogelesegang. Mokwadi o ne a ba a kaya ka go itwela ga morafe wa Baxhosa kgatlhanong le go gapiwa ke Maesemane. O ne a bolela gore Maburu ba ne ba tswa kwa Kapa ka ntlha ya go lemoga fa banni ba koo ba ne ba le kgatlhanong le bokgoba. Ka jalo ba ne ba tsamaela kwa go neng go le merafe ya Batswana kwa ba neng ba lemogile gore fa ba tlhoka batho ba ba ka ba direlang ditiro tse di bokete ba laela kwa dikgosing gore di ba fe batho mme e re morago ga gore ba ba direle tiro eo ba seke ba ba fe sepe, le fa e le dijo tota. Go ya ka mokwadi yoo, kgatelelo le pogiso tse di neng di dirwa ke Maburu mo bathong ba e ne e gaisa le e e neng e dirwa mo goo bone ke Matebele a ga Moselekatse, a kaya ka go betswa ka dithupa tse di dirilweng ka matlalo a ditshukudu le dipadi tse di neng di bonala mo mekwatleng ya ba ba biditsweng go balelwa le tsone Dikgosi le banna ba makgotla tota!

O bile a wetsa ka go tlhagisa gore batho ba ba jesetswang mo kgobedung ba, ba itse kwa maatla a bone a tla tswang teng ka jaana ditlhobolo le marumo di rekiwa ka bontsi mme di fitlhiwa ka manontlhotlho a e leng gore ke Maburu a se kae fela a a lemogang gore dibetsa tse di phuthiwang tse di tsile go tsisa borai jo bo kae mo go bone.

Mokwadi yo o neng a kwala polelo eo, e ne e le Ngaka David Livingstone yo ka nako eo a neng a nna kwa Kolobeng le morafe wa Bakwena le Kgosi ya bone Kgosi Kgari Sechele I. Ka nako e a neng a kwala ka yone o ne a setse a batliwa ke mookamedi wa Maburu a ko Teransefala, Andries Potgieter ka go bo a thusitse Bakwena ka dibetsa. Livingstone o ne a le Kgatlhanong le go dirwa ga batho makgoba. E rile go bona Maburu ba bogisa Batswana kwa Teransefala a gwetlhega go thusa Kgosi Sechele ka dibetsa. Karolo e ya botshelo jwa gagwe e tlhagelela thata mo dikwalong tsa gagwe tse a neng a di kwalela batho ba tshwana le ba lelwapa la gagwe le Robert Moffat. Mo lengweng la dikwalo tse, le a neng a le kwalela morwa rraagwe Charles, o ne a tlhalosa gore Maburu ba bogisa merafe ya Batswana ebile ba ba tsaya jaaka makgoba.O tsweletse a bolela gore ba ka bo ba ne ba bogisa Bakwena le Kgosi Sechele fela jalo fa a ne a sa thusa go gololа Bakwena mo go bone. O ne a kaya gore Bakwena ba ne ba rekile palo e e bonalang ya ditlhobolo mme Maburu a ne a tshoga gore merafe e mengwe e ka nna ya tsaya malebela mo go bone le yone ya di reka.

Mo lekwalong le a le kwaletseng batsadi ba gagwe ka 1950 o ne a tlhalosa gore o akanya go iphemela mo bakgokgontshing bao le babolai ke go obamela taolo ya Modimo. O ne a ba a re "tsela e le esi e re kgonneng ka yone gore ditshegofatso tsa selegodimo di somarele boipuso jwa rona re le setshaba ke go dirisa tsone ditlhobolo tseo tse le akanyang gore batho ba ba ne ba sa tshwanela go nna le tsone. Morafe o o kabo o ne wa seka wa nna le sebaka sa go akola mafoko a a molemo fa e ne e se ka go dirisa tsone ditlhobolo tseo.

Ngwaga wa 2013 o tshwaya dingwaga tse di makgolo mabedi fa e sale ka botsalo jwa ga Livingstone. E re re tsweletse re dira ditiro tse di farologanyeng tsa segopotso sa gagwe mo Botswana le mo mafatsheng a mangwe a kgaolo eno, go mo gakologelwa jaaka motsamai yo a neng a etela mafelo a a farologanyeng go ithuta mo go one go iditse gore a bonwe jaaka motho yo neng a na le maitsetsepelo a go emela se a dumelang mo go sone le go fetola dilo jaaka sone seemo sa kgatelelo le bokgoba se Maburu a neng a tsentse merafe ya Batswana mo go sone.

From the London Missionary Society to the UCCSA

Rev M.P.T. Basele

It is difficult to talk about Botswana without London Missionary Society because Batswana are what they are because of the church's hard work and immense contribution in their lives. Please take a short walk with me in the footsteps of our forefathers and foremothers. [Psalms 44:01-08]

The London Missionary Society (LMS) was started by committed and enthusiastic Christians whose motive was to pray together, read scripture and discuss challenging issues that emanated from the Lord's commission as found in Matthew 20:18-20 which reads, "Go ye therefore, and teach all nations; baptizing them in the name of the Father, and the Son and of the Holy Ghost: Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and lo! I will be with you always, even unto the end of the world". Since these Christians were from different denominations, it is interesting to note that these people of God held their first meeting at the Baker's Coffee House in London in November 1794 to discuss the formation of a missionary society.

As the meetings continued to become more fruitful, a Missionary Society that had an interdenominational outlook was formed on the 21st September 1795.The missionary society had to later change its name to London Missionary Society. The first missionaries were sent to Tahiti in 1796 while the second group was sent to Sierra Leone in 1797. The pioneer missionary to reach Africa was Rev. Dr. Theodorus Johannes van der Kemp, a Dutch Medical Doctor and a Military Chaplain. Later, he and his other colleagues landed in Cape Town on the 31st March 1799.

About twenty years after the first Missionary, a young Scot, Robert (18 years) arrived in South Africa in 1817and later proceeded to Kuruman where he settled among the Bechuanas and established a mission station.

DAVID LIVINGSTONE.

David Livingstone was born on the 19th March 1813 at Blantyre in Scotland. After completing his medical studies at Glasgow University in 1840, David was ordained later the same year by London Missionary Society.

He was recruited by Robert Moffat's speeches on Africa when Robert was visiting Great Britain. David was trained to serve in China but could not go because when he was about to go, Great Britain went to war with China and LMS decided that he should go to Southern Africa instead. Livingstone was one of the first Missionaries to bring the Gospel of Jesus Christ in Southern Africa through LMS. He married Mary Moffat, the daughter of Robert Moffat who founded the Kuruman Moffat Mission in South Africa.

In Botswana, Reverend David Livingstone and his wife Mary set up the first mission station near the village of Kumakwane at Kolobeng River in 1847 (the ruins still found there) where he befriended and converted the Bakwena Paramount Chief, Kgosi Kgari Sechele I to Christianity. While at Kolobeng he established the first church and a school where converts were taught how to read the bible. He also built a health facility and took advantage of the never drying Kolobeng River to introduce irrigation.

As Reverend Dr. Bwalya S. Chuba, a Zambian national who wrote extensively about the history of the LMS rightly says, the LMS was a "demonstration of an ideal united Christian Organization more than just an ecumenical enterprise in the Christian church". Hence, the UCCSA was formed by missionary society bodies, namely, The Bantu Congregational Church, the American Board of Foreign Missions, the Congregational Union

of South Africa, Church Aid and Missionary Society of Southern Africa and the London Missionary Society. On the 3rd October 1967 in Durban, South Africa, the above-said Christian Organizations dissolved their respective constitutions to enter into a solemn covenant that established the United Congregational Church of Southern Africa. Currently, the UCCSA is found in South Africa; Botswana; Namibia; Zimbabwe and Mozambique.

The UCCSA has made significant contribution to the educational, social and political development of Botswana. We would not be wrong, to claim the custody of the lease of Botswana as Rev. William C. Willoughby accompanied the three Dikgosi who went to seek British Protection against the Boers in 1885; Rev A. A. F. Lock was the first Speaker of the National Assembly after Botswana's independence and Rev. Dr A. Merriwhether took the baton from Rev. Lock as Speaker of the National Assembly. The first Mayor of the town of Gaborones, Rev Derek Jones is also a member of the UCCSA.

It is an undeniable truth that most political and civil leadership when Botswana attained independence were graduates of various institutions of the UCCSA and the current Cabinet is dominated by members of the UCCSA.

We thank God that he sent his servants to serve and spread the Gospel through LMS/UCCSA in other parts of the world and in particular Botswana.



UCCSA church, Molepolole

Go tloga London Missionaty Society go isa go UCCSA

Moruti M.P.T. Basele

Lekgotla la London Miss ionary Society (LMS) le simolotswe ke setlhopha sa Bakeresete ba ba neng ba itlamile go sala tumelo ya bone morago mme maikaelelo a bone e le go rapela le go ithuta lefoko la Modimo mmogo. Gape ba ne ba buisanya ka dikgwetlho tse ba lebaganyeng le tsone mo go diragatseng thomo ya go rerela ditshaba tsotlhe mafoko a a molemo le go kolobetsa ba ba dumelang mo leineng la Rara le la Morwa le la Mowa o o Boitshepho. Badumedi ba ba ne ba kopana jaana ba tswa mo dikerekeng tse di farologanyeng mme ba tshwaraganela go tlhama lekgotla le le lengwe le le ka thusang go tsamaisa lefoko la Modimo mo ditshabeng tsotlhe tsa lefatshe.

Fa bokopano jwa badumedi ba bo ntse bo tia, jwa bo simolola go ntsha maduo, lekgotla le le ne la simolodisiwa ka Kgwedi ya Ngwanatsele e le masome mabedi le bongwe ka ngwaga wa 1795. Badiredi ba ntlha ba lone ba ne ba romelwa kwa Tahiti ka 1796 mme lekoko le le latelang la romelwa kwa Sierra Leone ka 1797. Badiredi ba ntlha go goroga mo Aferika ba akaretsa Moruti Theodorus Johannes Van der Kemp le bangwe ka ene b aba neng ba goroga ko kapa ka kgwedi ya Mopitlo e le masome mararo le bongwe. Dingwaga di le masome mabedi morago ga moo, ka 1817 go ne ga goroga Robert Moffat yo o neng a tlhoma boremelelo jwa thuto ya lefoko la Modimo kwa Kudumane.

Moruti Ngaka David Livingstone ene o tshotswe ka kgwedi ya Mopitlo e le lesome le borobabongwe ka 1813 kwa Blantyre kwa Scotland. Morago ga go wetsa dithuto tsa gagwe tsa bongaka kwa Glasgow University ka 1840, o ne a bewa diatla ke ba London Missionary Society. O ne a rotloeditswe ke se se neng se buiwa ke Robert Moffat ka ga Aferika fa a ne a etetse Ennyelane. Livingstone o ne a nna mongwe wa bareri ba lefoko la Modimo ba ntlha go rera mafoko a a molemo mo borwa jwa Aferika. O ne a nyala Mary Moffat, morwadia Robert Moffat. Ka 1847 ba ne ba aga ntlo ya bone le kago ya kobamelo tse masalela a tsone a santseng a bonala kwa Kolobeng. Ke gone kwa a neng a tsalana le Kgosi Kgari Sechele I wa Bakwena a ba a mo sokolola le go mo kolobetsa. O ne a tlhoma kereke ya ntlha le sekolo se ko go sone ba ba dumetseng ba neng ba rutwa go bala baebela. Gape go ne go na le fa a thusetsang batho teng ka tsa botsogo.Gape on a ruta batho ba foo go dirisa metsi a noka ya Kolobeng e e neng e nna fela e tswelela le temo ya nosetso.

Mo tsamaong ya nako lekgotla la London Missionary Society le ne la felela le kopana le a mangwe jaaka the Bantu Congregational Church, the American Board of Foreign Missions, the Congregational Union of South Africa, Church Aid and Missionary Society of Southern Africa go dira United Congregational Church of Southern Africa ka kgwedi ya Phalane e le malatsi a le mararo ka 1967 kwa Durban kwa South Africa. Gompieno kereke e ya United Congregational Church of Southern Africa e fitlhelwa mo Botswana, South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe le Mozambique.

Kereke e e nnile le seabe se se bonalang mo tlhabololong ya thuto, sepolotiki, botsogo le tsa matshelo a batho mo lefatsheng la Batswana fa e sale e tlhongwa. Dingwe tsa tse di kayang seabe sa yone mo kgatelong pele ya sepolotiki ke go bo Moruti William Willoughby a ne a pata Dikgosi Tse Tharo tse di neng tsa etela kwa Enyelanne ka 1885 go ya go kopela Lefatshe leno tshireletso ya ga Mmamosadinyana kgatlhanong le maburu a a neng a gomagometsa go tseela merafe ya Batswana lefatshe. Moruti A. A. F. Lock ene o ne a nna Motsamaisa Dipuisanyo tsa Palamente wa ntlha morago ga boipuso, Moruti Ngaka A Merriwhether ene a ne a tsaya maemo a go tsamaisa Dipuisanyo tsa Palamente mo go Moruti Lock fa a ne a wetsa lebaka la gagwe mo tirong eo. Moruti Derek Jones ene o ne a nna Ratoropo wa ntlha wa toropoya Gaborone. Le gompieno jaana bontsi jwa matona a puso ya Botswana ke bakereki ba kereke ya UCCSA.

A Survey of the Missionary Landscape in Botswana

P. Segadika, Head of Archaeology and Monuments, Botswana National Museum

In the 19th century, missionaries traveled to many destinations which included places like Latin America, China, India and Africa. Their aim was to convert people in these areas to the Christian religion. These missionaries by and large came from Europe. Southern Africa, particularly Botswana, made contact with some of these missions. The London Missionary Society (LMS), a Protestant society founded in 1795 arguably, was the first mission body to make contact with the Batswana although other mission bodies later followed suit. The main aim of the London Missionary Society in Southern Africa was to convert Batswana to the Christian religion.

Generally, the missionaries tended to deplore immorality and emphasized righteousness, equality and condemned all sorts of injustices meted out to the underprivileged. Besides their attempts at conversion, they hoped that they would teach Batswana western values and hopefully transform the Batswana societies into something similar to their own. Initially, conversion and acceptance of western values were difficult to achieve but gradually they permeated Batswana societies.

As early as 1801 some of Batswana groups had made contact with itinerant traders from the coast. The contact with the traders had an impact on the Batswana societies, by virtue of items of trade that were exchanged. However, a more significant force that had a long lasting effect on the Batswana societies was that of the missionaries.

The first LMS missionaries to make contact with a group of Batswana were Rogers Edwards and John Kok who labored among the Griqua and Batlhaping found in present day Northern Cape and Northwest provinces of South Africa. Other missionaries in the likes of John Campbell, John Evans also visited Batlhaping where they were domiciled at Dithakong (Lathakoo). Initially, the impact of the LMS on these groups was minimal as the leaders of the Batlhaping, on account of their interest in arms trade and other western material goods which they regarded as more important.

The missionaries who had impact not only among the Batlhaping, but a significant population of the Batswana were Robert Moffat and David Livingstone. Arriving in South Africa in 1817, Robert Moffat, after a three year stint with the Griqua, persuaded the Batlhaping, on account of its strategic location, to settle near the Kudumane River, specifically near what has been termed as "the eye of Kuruman" because of the perennial flow of water from its fountain. Moffat, together with other missionaries like Robert Hamilton, were instrumental in setting up the Kudumane Mission Station. Subsequently, this mission station became an important learning centre as well as a significant anchor from which visitations by the subsequent missionaries into the interior would take place. It was from this base that LMS missionaries made contact with the Batswana at large in the interior.

The Kudumane mission is also very significant in that it did not only serve the people among whom it was established, the Batlhaping, but it trained Evangelists many of whom became responsible for the extensive spread of Christian beliefs among the Batswana . While initially Robert Moffat, like other missionaries before him, had problems in being accepted by the Batlhaping society in its entirety, after a couple of years he was recognized and accepted by the Batlhaping and other Batswana groups in the area for having protected Batlhaping during the Difaqane wars . His intentions went a long way in implicitly convincing many a Batswana ruler to have a missionary in their midst. It should, however, be emphasized that this acceptance was more on material grounds than religious persuasion. Among his achievements was the translation of the Bible into Setswana.

As a policy, the missionaries targeted Batswana leadership in the conversion process. The idea was to win the dikgosi to their fold, with the hope that once the dikgosi had been converted, they would use their power and influence to persuade their subjects to follow suit. As already mentioned, this strategy did not always produce the expected results, at least at its initial stages. It was the missionaries dedication and perseverance that eventually brought about the level of acceptance they needed from ordinary Batswana. Gradually however, the missionaries became accepted, not only because of being associated with military prowess, but because they were perceived as people who gave good advice, especially to the dikgosi in matters dealing with governance and the presence of the Europeans .

Another missionary who made a significant impact on the Batswana at the initial stages of contact was David Livingstone, that famous missionary who traveled extensively across the lands of southern, central and eastern Africa. Arriving in South Africa in 1841 David Livingstone was one of the architects of the L.M.S. expansion. Like other missionaries that would come after him, Livingstone used Kudumane mission station as a base for visiting the Batswana communities. As a result of these visitations, he made contact with a number of Batswana societies which included, Bakwena, Bangwato, and Batawana. It was among the Bakwena while at Kolobeng, between modern day Gaborone and Thamaga that Livingstone made a significant impact on the Batswana, specifically the Bakwena and, subsequently, the Batswana at large.

It was at Kolobeng that Livingstone, in typical missionary strategy, befriended Kgosi Sechele of the Bakwena and subsequently converted the Kgosi to the Christian religion . While Kgosi Sechele's subjects did not approve of his conversion to the new faith, Sechele himself was way ahead of his subjects and other apprehensive dikgosi in relation to his foresightedness which was to be testimony to the pervasive missionary impact that would affect the Batswana. Not only did Livingstone convert Kgosi Sechele to Christian religion, he also taught him how to read the Bible, how to write and a little bit of arithmetic. Therein Livingstone had laid a base upon which literacy and Christianity would proliferate not only among the Bakwena, but also among the Batswana at large.

It has already been mentioned that most of the dikgosi were not over-zealous about the Christian religion, preferring their sons and some of their subjects to be introduced to the new faith. However, Khama, the subsequent Kgosi of the Bangwato took to the Christian faith with some zeal. Missionaries labeled him 'Khama the Good', 'Khama the Great'. Missionary Schullenburg of the Hermansburg Missionary Society had converted Khama while still in exile in Sechele's country. Under him churches, schools, literacy were generally accepted and encouraged and were, just like in the case of Sechele, to have far reaching consequences on the Bangwato and the Batswana at large. Kgosi Khama himself was a staunch Christian, making sure that the Sabbath day was observed and that alcohol of any sort was prohibited.

Virtually all the 'principal' ethnic groups of the present day Botswana had a missionary in their midst. In point of fact, it was popular for Batswana *merafe* to have a missionary amongst them - almost to a point of competition. Thus, the Batawana, an offshoot of the Bangwato had settled around Lake Ngami in the late 18th century and had a missionary J.D. Hepburn, operating from among the Bangwato. He started mission work among the Batawana around 1877. While the kgosi welcomed Christian teaching, he was not as keen as Khama, but he had a tendency of encouraging the young and the women to be converted and taught Christian faith. By the 1880's the effects of missionary teachings mostly by evangelists, were evident among the Batswana as more Batawana showed interest in reading and writing and building a church.

The Bangwaketse were also not to be left out in this competition for missionaries. By 1871 James Good had consolidated missionary activity in Kanye, A teacher evangelist by the name of Sebobi, and trained at Kudumane mission station had been spreading the word of God among the Bangwaketse from as early as the 1850s. He is credited with having converted Kgosi Gaseitsiwe and his wife to the Christian religion as well as teaching him to read and write. Gaseitsiwe was to encourage the building of the church and the spread of literacy. Some Bangwaketse were anti-Christian leading to a civil war of 1887 sparked by the refusal of Christian adherents to participate in traditional ceremonies . The situation among the Bangwaketse stabilized during the time of Bathoeng I who took over after his father's death. He was as staunch a Christian as Kgosi Khama and encouraged the proliferation of Christianity and literacy.

Bakgatla first made contact with missionaries while they were still in the Transvaal. It is important however to note that missionaries who made contact with the Bakgatla were not the LMS as had been the case with other Batswana groups. Instead, these missionaries belonged to the Cape Missionary Society of the Dutch Reformed

Church and had, as early as 1862, made contact with the Bakgatla in Western Transvaal under the guidance of Andrew Murray. The Bakgatla, under the heavy handed rule of Paul Kruger, had not yet moved to present day Mochudi. When Paul Kruger's exploitative and harsh rule became unbearable, a large section of the Bakgatla moved to Mochudi in 1870, an area then under Kgosi Sechele of the Bakwena.

The Dutch Missionaries followed, first making intermittent visits and finally establishing a permanent mission station in Mochudi. Kgosi Kgamane though himself not a Christian initially, encouraged its teachings alongside literacy. Rev. P. Brink was the first resident missionary among Bakgatla in Mochudi (1877). Taking advantage of the Bakgatla's leadership willingness to accept Christianity and its teachings, he encouraged the building of a church and some schools. In this endeavour he was also helped by teacher evangelist in the likes of Leoke Mariri stationed at (Sikwane), Abel Ratladi (Morwa) and T. Phiri (Malolwane) . Missionary impact was now becoming significant among most Batswana groups and was growing stronger from the humble beginnings of Robert Moffat in Kudumane. Not all Batswana groups made contact with the LMS missionaries. The Balete of present day Ramotswa made contact with missionaries through the Lutheran Mission Society headed by the missionary Reverend Shullenburg in 1859. The Balete, like the Bakgatla, had fled from the oppressive rule of the Boers and had also been given refuge at Mmankgodi by the Bakwena . The kgosi of the Balete, Mokgosi I, requested the presence of a missionary, just like other Batswana groups were doing, no so much for religious as was for secular reasons, and by 1865 Shullenburg had become Resident Missionary of the Balete . Mokgosi encouraged the acceptance of Christian teachings. He became instrumental in mobilizing Balete to build a church, schools and the spread of literacy, which proliferated among the Balete, another positive impact of missionary endeavours.

The Barolong came into contact with the missionaries through the Methodist Church, "which had been founded in England in about 1732, initially as a movement within the Church of England but separated in the 18th century . The Methodist Mission Society was founded in the 1870's and quickly spread to other parts of the world, Southern Africa included. In South Africa it made contact initially with the Griqua and the Bergenaars but later with the Barolong, around the Molopo River and Thaba Nchu in the Orange Free State. Thabanchu became the great historic headquarters of the Methodists in the same way that Kuruman was for the L.M.S.

The Barolong of Botswana, Montshioa-Barolong, were first introduced to Christianity through the Revd I.D.M. Ludorf in 1851 Ludorf was able to convert a reasonable number of Barolong, probably on account of his medical skills . He also introduced literacy, and encouraged the Barolong to spread the word of God and literacy amongst their own people. Like other Batswana groups, teacher evangelists played a significant role in spreading the word among their own people as exemplified by the Reverend Leshomo, Molema and Montshioa families over the years.

Other *merafe* of Batswana which came into contact with the missionaries, but indirectly so, were the 'subject groups'. These were groups that owed allegiance to the more powerful ones. The subsequent position of these groups came through conquest, subjugation or protection. Developments usually started with the major groups and reached the 'subject' groups later. Christianity and its values therefore did not reach the subject groups until after it had come through the dominant groups first. The Batswapong and the Hambukushu did not come to be part of the Bangwato and Batawana churches respectively until 1887. Meanwhile Christianity and its values had been established much earlier among the 'major' groups. Even when Christianity did reach these groups, it did so through teacher evangelists, but never through permanent white resident missionaries as was the case with the majority groups.

It would appear that missionaries did not make any serious attempts to reach out to the 'subject' groups such as Bakgalagadi and Basarwa. Mgadla has observed that "as a matter of fact the aristocracy in this part of the world deliberately prevented mission teachings from spreading among these groups". Missionaries might have had intentions of reaching out to these groups but were deterred by the attitude of the aristocracy which had a low opinion of these groups. When the Missionary Wookey Wookey of the LMS visited the desert for the purpose of evangelizing Bakgalagadi and Basarwa, Kgosi Sechele is alleged to have remarked "even the dogs were being fed from the King's table".

The Bakalanga who were 'subjects' of the Bangwato had Christianity reaching them through the agents of the Bangwato. No white missionary is known to have resided among the Bakalanga of present day Botswana. In fact, the Bangwato teacher evangelists were not dispatched to the Bakalanga area until after 1895. The only Bakalanga who were exposed to the new teachings were those who were fortunate enough to be geographically located near the capital of the Bangwato. Thus, the Reverend Motiki was not sent to Baka Nswazwi until 1899.

Be that as it may, a fundamental point to be made about missionary activity among the Batswana groups was the fact that even though the leadership almost showed apprehension to conversion, it implicitly acknowledged Christianity which became a state religion observed in most Sabbath days. The LMS in its areas of operation, the DRC, the Lutherans, the Methodists were recognized as state churches by the various groups among whom they operated. The Catholics and the Seventh Day Adventists, in addition to conversion, offered services in education and medical health respectively by virtue of their late arrival in the territory.



UCCSA church, Gaborone

Tshekatsheko Ya Bodiredi Jwa Dimmishenari mo Botswana

P. Segadika, Head of Archaeology and Monuments, Botswana National Museum

Ka dingwaga tsa bo 1800, bareri ba lefoko la Modimo, bontsi jwa bone ba tswa kwa Yuropa, ba ne ba ya kwa mafelong a a farologanyeng jaaka Latin America, China, India le Aferika. Maikaelelo a bone e ne e le go sokololela batho kwa tumelong ya sekeresete. Bangwe ba bone ba ne ba tla mo borwa jwa Aferika. Lekgotla la bareri ba go nna jalo la ntlha go romela badiredi ba lone mo borwa jwa Aferika, bogolo jang mo Botswana ke la London Missionary Society (LMS). Bareri ba ba ne ba kgala mekgwa e e bosula ya go sa itsaya sentle mme ba rotloetsa tshiamo le tekatekano.Gape ba ne ba kgala go sa tsewa sentle ga ba ba tlhokileng lesego mo setshabeng.Gape ba ne ba solofela gore ba kgone go ruta Batswana mekgwa ya bone ya botshelo, mme se se ne se se motlhofo.

Bareri ba ntlha go amana le merafe ya Batswana ke Rogers Edwards le John Kok ba ba neng ba dira le merafe ya Griqua le Batlhaping.Batlhaping ba ne gape ba etelwa ke John Campbell le John Evans.Kwa tshimologong baeteledipele ba merafe e ba ne ba na le kgatlhego mo go rekeng ditlhobolo go gaisa jaaka ba ne ba kgatlhegela tiro ya bareri ba.

Bareri ba ba neng ba ama matshelo a Batlhaping le merafe e mengwe ya Batswana ka tsela e e bonalang ke Robert Moffat le David Livingstone. E rile a sena go goroga kwa Aferika Borwa ka 1817, Robert Moffat a kgona go rotloetsa Batlhaping go fudugela gaufi le noka ya Kudumane ka go bo e ne e sa kgale.Ene le bareri ba bangwe jaaka Robert Hamilton ba ne ba tlhoma boremelelo jwa thero ya lefoko la Modimo gone kwa Kudumane. Ke gone kwa bareri ba bangwe ba neng ba etela merafe e mengwe ya Batswana ba tswa teng mme ba bo ba feta ba direla kwa go yone merafe eo.Ka jalo ba ne ba kgona go anamisa efangele mo Batswaneng ka bophara. Le fa e rile go le pele ba ne ba nna le dikgwetlho tsa go amogelwa ke Batlhaping, morago ga dingwaga di le mmalwa ba ne ba mo amogela ka jaana a ne a thusitse go ba sireletsa ka nako ya dintwa tsa Difaqane. Se se ne sa dira gore Dikgosi di le dintsi di dumele fa go le botlhokwa go nna le moreri wa lefoko la Modimo mo gare ga bone. Tumelo ya bareri ba e ne e le gore fa ba setse ba amogetswe ke baeteledipele ba merafe (Dikgosi) go tla nna motlhofo go amogelwa ke merafe ka kakaretso le go ba sokolola.Tse dingwe ditiro tse a neng a nna le seabe mo go tsone ke go ranolela baebele kwa setswaneng. Kwa bofelong Batswana ba ne ba ba amogela, e seng fela ka go bo ba ne ba thusa mo go tsa itshireletso, mme le ka go bo ba ne ba fa dikgakololo tse di molemo, bogolo jang mo dikgosing, ka ga
tse di amanang le puso e e lolameng le gore ba ka dira jang ka boleng teng jwa basweu
ba ba tswang Yuropa mo gare ga bone.

Ngaka David Livingstone ene e ne ya re a sena go goroga kwa Aferika Borwa ka 1841, a nna le seabe se segolo mo go anameng ga thuto ka lekgotla la London Missionary Society. O ne a etela merafe ya Batswana e e neng e le mo kgaolong eo a tswa kwa Kudumane mme a felela a tsisitse bodiredi jwa gagwe mo merafeng e tshwana ya Bakwena, Bangwato le Batawana.

Ka nako ya fa a ne a na le Bakwena kwa Kolobeng, o ne a tsalana le Kgosi Kgari Sechele I. a bo a mo sokololela kwa sekereseteng. O ne gape a mo ruta go bala baebele, go kwala le go dira dipalo.Ka jalo o ne a dirile motheo wa thuto mo morafeng wa Bakwena e e neng wa jwelelela mo merafeng e mengwe ya Batswana.

Mo morafeng wa Bangwato, Kgosi Khama III o ne a amogela sekeresete ka maatlametlo mme a rotloetsa go tlhomiwa ga dikolo le dikereke a ba a emisa go nowa ga bojalwa.Se se ne sa fetola matshelo morafe wa Bangwato le merafe e mengwe ya Batswana ka kakaretso. Merafe ka bontsi e ne ya simolola go bona go le botlokwa go nna le moreri wa lefoko magareng ga bone, ka jalo Batawana ba ne ba amana J.D Hepburn go simolola ka 1877. Bangwaketse bone ba ne ba na le James Good go simolola ka 1871.Pele ga moo ba ne ba rutilwe lefoko ke Moefangedi Sebobi yo o neng a kgona go sokolola Kgosi Gaseitsiwe le mohumagadi wa gagwe.Gape o ne a ba rutile go bala le go kwala.Kgosi Gaseitsiwe o ne a rotloetsa go agiwa ga kereke le go anamisiwa ga thuto ya go bala le go kwala.

Bakgatla bone ba ne ba simolola go dirisanya le bareri ba ba lefoko, fa ba santse ba le ka kwa Teransefala kwa Aferika Borwa ka 1862. Bareri ba e ne e le ba lekgotla la Cape Missionary Society go tswa mo kerekeng ya Dutch Reformed. Fa Bakgatla ba ne ba fudugela kwa Mochudi ka 1870 go tshaba puso ya kgokgontsho ya Maburu a ga Paul Kruger, bareri ba ba lefoko ba ne ba tswelela ba ntse ba na le bone mme ba felela ba tlhoma boremelelo jwa bodiredi jwa bone kwa Mochudi.Moreri wa ntlha go direla mogare ga bone kwa Mochudi ka 1877 e ne e le Moruti P. Brink. O ne a rotloetsa go agiwa ga kereke le dikolo.

Le fa go ntse jalo ga se merafe yotlhe ya Batswana e e neng ya tsisediwa bodiredi jwa thero ya mafoko a a molemo ke lekgotla la London Missionary Society. Balete kwa Ramotswa bone ba ne ba bona bodiredi jwa go nna jalo mo go ba Lutheran Mission Society ba ba neng ba romela koo Moruti Shullenburg ka 1859.Balete jaaka merafe e mengwe ba ne ba ne ba tshabile puso ya kgatelelo ya Maburu mme ba fiwa botshabelo kwa Mmankgodi ke Bakwena.Kgosi Mokgosi I o ne a rotloetsa morafe wa gagwe go amogela dithuto tsa sekeresete ga mmogo le go aga kereke le sekolo se se neng sa anamisa kitso ya go bala le go kwala.

Barolong bone ba ne ba bona bodiredi jwa thero ya efangele ka kereke ya Methodist kana Wesele e e neng e tlhamilwe kwa Ennyelane ka 1732. E ne e kile ya bo e le lekalana la Church of England mme ya ikemela ka nosi ka dingwaga tsa bo 1700.Barolong ba kopane le bodiredi jo ba santse ba le kwa Aferika Borwa mo tikologong ya noka ya Molopo le Thaba Nchu kwa Orange Free State.Thaba Nchu e ne ya nna boremelelo jwa bodiredi jwa bareri ba Wesele jaaka Kuruman e ne e le boremelelo jwa bodiredi jwa bareri ba London Missionary Society. Barolong ba ga Montshioa ba ba neng ba le ka kwano mo Botswana ba ne ba tsisediwa dithuto tsa sekeresete ke Moruti I.D.M Ludorf ka 1851.Le ene o ne a anamisa kitso ya go bala le go kwala.

Merafe e mengwe e ne ya kopana le thero ya lefoko la Modimo e fetela kwa go bone go tswa kwa merafeng e e neng e e okametse. Sekai ke gore Batswapong ba ne ba nna bontlha bongwe jwa phuthego kwa morago e setse e tlhomilwe ke morafe o o neng o ba okametse wa Bangwato. Hambukushu le bone ba ne ba nna bontlha jwa kereke e e neng e tlhomilwe ke Batawana. Merafe e mengwe jaaka Bakgalagadi le Basarwa go lebega go ne ga seka ga nna le maiteko a a kalo a go isa bodiredi jwa thero ya efangele kwa go bone. Bakalanga bone efangele e ne ya fitlha kwa go bone ka badiredi ba Bangwato morago ga 1895.

Kwa bofelong go katwe le fa baeteledipele ba merafe ya Batswana kwa tshmologong ba ne ba sa kgatlhegele go sokologela kwa sekereseteng, mme mo tsamaong ya nako ya nna yone tumelo e e tshegeditsweng ke merafe ka bontsi.

Envisaged Infrastructural Developments at David Livingstone Kolobeng National Monument

Vasco Baitseseng and Powell Motsumi

It was on a beautiful sunny African day of 15 September 2013 when several Members of Parliament, high ranking government officials, multitudes of members of the United Congregation Church of Southern Africa (UCCSA), and the people of Kumakwane descended on Kolobeng David Livingstone Memorial Monument about 3km west of Kumakwane village in the Kweneng District. This was no ordinary day as jubilant congregants stomped their feet, sang beautiful church melodies and ululated in remembrance of their legendary pastor, David Livingstone. The day started with a thanksgiving church service to celebrate the contribution of the famous pioneer pastor, medical Doctor and explorer, David Livingstone, to the socio-economic and political development of modern day Botswana.

The church service was followed by a ground breaking ceremony for infrastructural developments the Minister of Environment, Wildlife and Tourism, Honourable Tshekedi Khama. The developments include a gatehouse, ablution block and a campsite. The gatehouse building will comprise of an office for custodians, reception area, a small interpretation room, a small curio shop that will for selling crafts from locals, a kitchenette, store room and toilets that will be used by both tourists and custodians. There will also be an ablution block and a campsite on site. The developments will be constructed using locally available materials grass for thatching and rocks for building structure. Residents of Kumakwane will be employed to provide labour during the construction stage of the project. Qualified local tradesmen like builders, carpenters, plumbers and electricians will also be engaged at different stages of the project.

It is anticipated that once the infrastrutural developments are complete, the community will derive benefit from the site by charging fees and the sale of crafts and curios.



Ground breaking ceremony by Minister Khama.



Standard gatehouse under construction at Kolobeng

The developments are part of the Department of National Museum and Monuments 100 Monuments Project. The 100 Monuments Project is implemented in partnership with the Department of Local Government and Rural Development (DLGRD) through the Ipelegeng programme. The project is part of His Excellency the President of the Republic of Botswana, Lieutenant General Seretse Khama Ian Khama's special projects. The project is aimed at developing selected heritage sites for tourism purposes with spill over benefits of providing short term employment and relief to communities while at the same time carrying out essential development projects. The programme overall enhances the protection, conservation and management of selected monuments as per the mandate of the Department of National Museum and Monuments.

Other planned activities for the celebration if David Livingstone's bi-centenary include a public lecture by various scholars on different topics on his life as well as an exhibition.



Members of the Soldiers Of Christ organ of the UCCSA



Moeding College students graced the ceremony

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Ditlhabololo tse di tlang kwa Kolobeng

Vasco Baitseseng and Powell Motsumi

E ne e le letsatsi le lentle fela thata la tshipi, bogogi jwa motse wa Kumakwane, bagolwane ba puso, maloko a kereke ya U.C.C.S.A le morafe ka kakaretso ba ne ba phuthegetse kwa Kolobeng go gakologelwa Moruti Ngaka David Livingstone. Segopotso se, e ne e le sa dingwaga tse di makgolo mabedi fa e sale ka botsalo jwa ga Livingstone. Se simolotswe ka tirelo ya kereke go lebogela Modimo botshelo le bodiredi jwa jwa ga Moruti Ngaka David Livingstone.

Morago ga tirelo ya kereke, Tona wa Tikologo, Diphologolo le Bojanala Motlotlegi Tshekedi Khama o ne a a simolodisa kgotsa a epa motheo wa dikago tsedi tlaa dirwang ko Kolobeng ke ba Lephata la Ditso le Ditsa Tlholego. Dikago tseo, di tlaa akaretsa lefelo la kamogelo baeng, matlwana a boitiketso le go tlhapela ga mmogo le fa baeng ba ka tlhomang ditante tsa borabalo teng.

Lefelo la kamogelo baeng le tla akaretsa ofisi ya badiri ba ba tlhokometseng lefelo le, kamore ya kamogelo baeng, kamore e e tla dirisetswang go ruta baeng ka bokao jwa Kolobeng, lefelo le le dirisetswang go rekisa dithoto tse di dirilweng ke banni ba metse e e mo tikologong tse ba di itiretseng ka diatla, kamore ya boapeelo, kamore ya bobeelo jwa dilwana, matlwana a boitiketso ga mmogo le fa go pakiwang dikoloi teng.

Kago e e tla dirwa ka lenaneo la go tlhabolola le go sireletsa mafelo a le lekgolo a a nang le bokao jwa ngwao le tlholego le le simolotsweng ke Motlotlegi Tautona wa Lefatshe la Botswana Lieutenant General Seretse Khama Ian Khama ka maikaelelo a go thusa Lephata La Ditso Le Ditsa-Tlholego go tlhabolola mafelo a gore a dirisediwe bojanala mme gape ka maikaelelo a gore Batswana ba dirise Lenaneo la Ipelegeng go tlhabolola lefatshe la bone gape ba oba letsogo.

Ditiragalo tse dingwe tsa go tshwaya segopotso sa ga Livingstone di akaretsa; go tshwarwa ga dipuisanyo le setshaba ka botshelo jwa mogaka yo le ditshupo ka botshelo jwa gagwe.



Tshimologo ya dikago tsa kamogelo baeng, Kolobeng

16 Years of Service at Kolobeng Monument

Alfred Piet



Mr Alfred Piet

I was employed by the Department of National Museum and Monuments as the first guide at Kolobeng - David Livingstone Memorial Monument on 8th December 1993. I was assigned to receive visitors, take them on a tour of the site, teach them on the history of Dr David Livingstone. I was also given the duty to keep the site clean for patrolling the fence to identify any damages that may have come up.

I have taught most local people and tourist from outside the country about Dr David Livingstone the missionary doctor and explorer who had studied theology and medicine in his country. Livingstone settled in Africa to work with Africans. He built a small church at Kolobeng where he preached the word of God. It is at Kolobeng where he met, converted and baptised Kgosi Kgari Sechele I of Bakwena. He also built a small house for his family. In front of the house there is a big stone which is said to be Livingstone's dental stone. This is where his patients sat while he attended to them. There is also a grave yard where his daughter Elizabeth was laid to rest and a portion of land which is said to have been used a workshop for repairing guns and other things. The remains of these structure are still evidant at Kolobeng.

Below is a sequence of dates marking important events in the life of Dr Livingstone.

19th March 1813
Birth of Dr Livingstone in Blantyre, Scotland
1836
Entered Anderson's College For Medicine and Theology
November 1840
Graduated as a doctor
8th December 1840
Sailed down to the Cape to meet Robert Moffat
2nd January 1845
Married Mary, the daughter of Robert Moffat
August 1847
set up a mission at Kolobeng
9th September 1862
Death of his wife at Shupanga
10th November 1871
Was met by H.M. Stanley
1st May 1873
Met his death at Ilala at chief Chitambo's village in Zambia. (Southeast of Lake Bangweulu)
His heart was buried under Mrula tree in Ilala now the site of Livingstone Memmorial.
18th April 1874
buried with national honours in Westminster Abbey, in London.

The Livingstone Memorial Site is visited by the following groups of visitors:
Local Visitors: University students to undertake research
College students come for educational tours
Secondary and primary schools visit the site for the educational tours
General public and tourists for enjoyment including picnics.
Local churches come for prayers and for solemnizing marriages

Dingwaga Tse Di Lesome Le Borataro Tsa Bodiredi Kwa Kolobeng

Alfred Piet

Ke thapilwe ke Lephata La Ditso le Ditsa-Tlholego ke le mokaedi wa baeng kwa Kolobeng ka kgwedi ya Sedimontlhole e le malatsi a roba bobedi ka 1993. Ke ne ka fiwa maikarabelo a go amogela baeng le go ba tsamaisa le lefelo ke ba ruta ka lone le ka ditso tsa ga Ngaka David Livingstone. Ditiro tsa me tse dingwe e ne e le go phepafatsa lefelo le, le go sekaseka terata ke lebelela gore a ga go a senyega gope.

Ngaka Livingstone yo o neng a ithutetse bongaka le boruti kwa lefatsheng la ga bone la Scotland, o ne a batla go tla go nna mo Aferika go direla teng. O ne a aga kereke e a neng a rera lefoko la Modimo mo go yone kwa Kolobeng. Ko Kolobeng ke teng ko a neng a kopana le Kgosi Kgari Sechele I wa Bakwena mme a mo sokolola a bo a mo kolobetsa. Gape o ne a aga ntlo e a neng a nna mo go yone le ba lelwapa la gagwe. Fa pele ga ntlo e go ne go na le letlapa le go bolelwang fa balwetse ba meno ba ne ba nna mo go lone fa ba tsile go kopa thuso mo go ene. Gape go na le mabitla fa go bolokilweng teng morwadie Elizabeth, le lefelo le go utlwalang a ne a le dirisa e le madirelo a go baakanya ditlhobolo.



Lentswe la ga Livingstone la bongaka jwa meno(Livingstone's dental stone) Kolobeng

Tse di latelang ke dinako tse di botlhokwa mo ditsong tsa botshelo jwa ga Ngaka Livingstone:

Mopitlo 19, 1813
Botsalo jwa ga ngaka Livingstone kwa Blantyre, Scotland.
1836
O ne a simolola dithuto kwa Anderson's College For Medicine and Theology
Ngwana tsele 1840
O ne a aloga e le ngaka
Sedimonthole 8, 1840
O ne a tsaya loeto go ya kwa Kapa go ya go kopana le moruti Robert Moffat
Herikgong 2, 1845
Ngaka Livingstone o ne a nyalana le Mary, Morwadia Robert Moffat
Phatwe 1847- O ne a simolodisa boremelelo jwa thero ya mafoko a a molemo kwa Kolobeng
Lwetse 9 1862- Mosadi wa gagwe Mary o ne a tlhokafala
Motsheganong 1, 1873- Ngaka Livingstone o ne a tlhokafalela ko Ilala gaufi le letsha la Bangweulu ko Zambia. Pelo ya gagwe e fitlhilwe ko tlase ga setlhore sa morula ko Ilala ko gompieno e leng lefelo la Livingstone Memorial la ditso.
Moranang 18, 1874 Mmele wa gagwe o ne wa bolokwa ka tlotla e e tshwanetseng mo kerekeng ya Westminster ko Lontone.

Lefelo le la Kolobeng le etelwa ke ditlhopha tse di latelang tsa baeng:
- Baithuti ba dikolo tse dikgolo ba le etela go ya go dira dipatlisiso le go tsamaisiwa le lone ba ithuta.
- Ba dikolo tse di kgolwane le tse di potlana ba etela koo ka maiteko a go tokafatsa lenaneo la dithuto.
- Bagolwane ba puso ba tsisa baeng ba ba emetseng mafatshe a mangwe go tla go ithuta ka lefelo le.
- Dikereke ka go farologana di tla go rapela le go tshwaraganya batho mo nyalong e e boitshepho.
- Setshaba ka kakaretso le sone se etela mo lefelong le go ithuta ka lone le go tshwara bokopano jwa go itlosa bodutu.

Y Care Charitable Trust Supports Our Heritage

Stellan Bengtsson, Coordinator



Y Care walkers in the Makgadikgadi Pans

Y Care Charitable Trust started from an inspiring dream to walk across the Makgadikgadi Pans to raise funds for charity. Succeeding to bring on board like-minded individuals with extensive knowledge of the pans, eagerness to experience an invigorating challenge and tremendous support staff, the first Makgadikgadi Pans walk took place in 2003.

Since the first walk in 2003, Y Care has raised close to P 3 million to charities and community projects in Botswana. Y Care is supporting charities and community projects which are working to assist women, vulnerable children, arts, sports and culture. Each year, 15-20 beneficiaries are selected and sharing the approx. P300,000 which are raised annually from the walks. The Y Care concept is unique: raising funds by organizing
sponsored walks in areas of cultural and historical significance where each walker has a personal and unforgettable experience during the 40-50 km of walking per day for 2-3 days and where the raised funds benefit charities and community projects in the areas of the walks.
Each year, approx. 150 corporate and individual walkers are taking part in the walks. Participating corporates, parastatals and organizations with their teams are using the walks as part of the CSR (Corporate Social Responsibility) but also as an opportunity for team building and networking. The community trusts which are managing the natural and cultural heritage sites in the areas of the walks are among the beneficiaries. In this

way, Y Care is benefitting by getting logistical assistance from the community trusts which then get financial support from Y Care. A perfect win-win situation for the benefit of our heritage sites!
From the very beginning, Y Care has worked closed together with Botswana National Museum. As all walks are organized in areas and sites of cultural and historical significance, Y Care is playing an important role to spread the knowledge and awareness about our heritage. For most of the walkers, it's the first time they have had an opportunity to visit these sites.

Y Care has organized walks to Tsodilo Hills, Domboshaba Ruins, Matenge Well /Rock paintings, Nlapkhwane Rock Paintings, Ntimbale Rock Paintings, Ntimbale Hill, Makgadikgadi Pans, Lekhubu Island, Tswapong Hills, LMS Church, Moremi Gorge and Tuli Block (incl. Solomon's wall). Each year, 3-4 sponsored walks are organized and held during the winter season.
In addition to the "famous" sites, Y Care is also promoting some of the less known heritage sites on the 100 Monuments list. This is done by organizing monthly half day guided walks to heritage sites in the Greater Gaborone area. In 2014, there will be organized 15 half day walks. These walks are called "Pre Walks" as they are preparation walks to the sponsored walks. The Pre Walks are open to the public and cover a distance of 15-25 km each. So far, the Pre Walks have visited Mmamotshwane Gorge, Manyana Site, Livingstone Tree, Segorong, Livingstone Kolobeng Memorial, Dithubaruba, Three Chiefs, Setletlekeke Bridge, El Negro and Tapong). Most of the walkers are amazed that we have such beautiful places within a short distance from Gaborone. More sites are planned to be included in the Pre Walks in collaboration with National Museum.

Y Care is proud to partner with the National Museum in the work to take the people to our heritage sites and expose them to the beauty of our country. All monuments and heritage sites need to be known to the public so they can be protected and well taken care of for future generations. Y Care is playing a vital role here.



Y Care walkers on top of female hill, Tsodilo





Livingstone tree, Manyana